

Archive Management Procedure

Document Information

Document Title: Archive Management Procedure

Project: Organize a Professional Digital Filing System

Document Type: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

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Prepared By: Omondi Mbara

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to establish a standardized process for archiving inactive or completed digital files while preserving their accessibility, integrity, and organization. Archiving helps maintain a clean and efficient filing system by separating active documents from records that must be retained for historical, legal, academic, or reference purposes.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all documents stored within the Professional Digital Filing System that are no longer actively used but should be retained for future reference.

Examples include:

- Completed projects
- Previous academic assignments
- Old reports
- Financial records
- Meeting minutes
- Completed presentations
- Outdated templates
- Previous versions of documents
- Archived correspondence

3. Responsibilities

The user is responsible for:

- Identifying documents suitable for archiving.
- Moving documents to the appropriate archive folder.
- Maintaining the original folder structure where practical.
- Applying consistent naming conventions.
- Ensuring archived documents remain accessible.
- Reviewing archived files periodically.

4. Archive Structure

The Professional Digital Filing System should include a dedicated archive folder.

Example:

```
Professional Digital Filing System
├── 10 Archive
│   ├── Administration
│   ├── Finance
│   ├── Projects
│   ├── School
│   ├── Books
│   ├── Personal
│   └── Media
```

This structure mirrors the active filing system, making archived files easy to locate.

5. Documents Suitable for Archiving

Archive documents that:

- Have been completed.
- Are no longer edited regularly.
- Must be retained for reference.
- Are required for record-keeping.
- Have been replaced by newer versions.
- Are associated with completed projects.

Do **not** archive documents that are still active or frequently updated.

6. Archive Procedure

Step 1: Identify Files to Archive

Review folders regularly and identify files that are no longer active.

Examples include:

- Completed project reports
 - Previous semester assignments
 - Closed financial records
 - Old presentations
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Step 2: Verify the File

Before archiving, confirm that:

- The document is complete.
 - No further editing is expected.
 - A final version exists.
 - The file is not duplicated elsewhere unnecessarily.
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Step 3: Create Archive Folders (If Necessary)

If an appropriate archive folder does not exist, create one using the same naming structure as the active folders.

Example:

```
10 Archive
└── Projects
```

Step 4: Move the File

Cut (**Ctrl + X**) the document from its active location.

Navigate to the archive folder and paste (**Ctrl + V**) the file into its new location.

Example:

Before:

```
04 Projects
└─ Completed Project Report.pdf
```

After:

```
10 Archive
└─ Projects
    └─ Completed Project Report.pdf
```

Step 5: Verify the Archive

Confirm that:

- The file has been moved successfully.
 - It opens correctly.
 - The folder structure remains organized.
 - The original folder no longer contains duplicate copies unless intentional.
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Step 6: Update Related Records

If applicable:

- Update project indexes.
 - Update documentation.
 - Record the archive date.
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7. Archive Naming Convention

Archived files should retain their original filenames whenever possible.

If additional identification is needed, append the archive year.

Examples:

8. Archive Review

Review archived folders at least once each year.

During the review:

- Remove unnecessary duplicates.
 - Confirm files remain accessible.
 - Update storage locations if required.
 - Verify backup copies exist.
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9. Best Practices

- Archive only completed or inactive files.
 - Maintain the same folder hierarchy within the archive.
 - Keep filenames descriptive.
 - Back up archived files regularly.
 - Do not mix archived files with active documents.
 - Document significant archiving activities where appropriate.
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10. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Archiving files that are still in active use.
 - Deleting files instead of archiving them.
 - Changing filenames unnecessarily.
 - Creating inconsistent archive folders.
 - Failing to back up archived data.
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11. Related Documents

- Document Filing Procedure
- Procedure for Saving Files
- File Retrieval Procedure

- File Backup and Recovery Procedure
 - Duplicate File Management Procedure
 - File Naming Convention Guide
 - Folder Structure Guide
 - User Guide
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12. Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	5 July 2026	Initial release.

13. Conclusion

An effective archive management process ensures that inactive documents are preserved without cluttering active working folders. By consistently archiving completed files, maintaining an organized archive structure, and performing regular reviews and backups, users can keep the Professional Digital Filing System efficient, organized, and easy to maintain while preserving valuable records for future reference.